

August 13, 2026

BlueChoice HealthPlan of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Unit
P.O. Box 6170
Columbia, SC 29260

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Minh Monahan (MRN MUSC7419998), Claim MUSC-17FF-1

Patient	Minh Monahan (DOB 2003-07-03)
MRN	MUSC7419998
Member ID / Group	BLU177743807 / GRP-38862
Claim number	MUSC-17FF-1
Date of service	2026-05-07
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$611.29
Denial code	CARC 151 / RARC N362 — Payer deems the information submitted does not support this many/frequency of services.
Appeal deadline	2026-09-17

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this first-level reconsideration on behalf of Minh Monahan (Member ID: BLU177743807, MRN: MUSC7419998) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-17FF-1 for services rendered on May 7, 2026, by Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI 1314059687). BlueChoice HealthPlan of South Carolina denied the claim in full — \$611.29 billed, \$0.00 paid — citing CARC 151 and RARC N362, with the payer remark stating: "Units billed exceed the plan's allowable frequency for this service." We respectfully assert that this denial is not supported by the facts of the claim and request immediate reversal and payment at the contracted rate.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Minh Monahan is a 23-year-old male patient with an established and documented history of recurrent upper respiratory conditions, including chronic sinusitis (active, onset 2014), seasonal allergic rhinitis (active), and atopic dermatitis (active). His medical history reflects a pattern of ongoing respiratory and allergic disease management, and he carries active prescriptions for loratadine and an epinephrine auto-injector, consistent with his allergic profile. On May 7, 2026, Mr. Monahan presented to MUSC Health University Medical Center as an established outpatient patient and was evaluated by Dr. Lindqvist for an acute upper respiratory infection (J06.9). The encounter was billed as a single unit of CPT 99214, an office or outpatient visit for an established patient requiring moderate medical decision-making. One unit of one service was submitted.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial under CARC 151 and RARC N362 is factually inapplicable to this claim. Both codes pertain to situations in which the number of units or frequency of a service exceeds a plan-defined threshold. However, Claim MUSC-17FF-1 was submitted with exactly one unit of CPT 99214 for a single date of service. There is no duplication, no repeat billing within a short interval, and no multi-unit submission that could logically trigger a frequency-based denial. A single evaluation and management visit by an established patient with active, documented medical conditions does not constitute excessive utilization by any reasonable clinical or administrative standard.

CPT 99214 is a widely recognized, appropriate code for an established-patient outpatient visit involving moderate complexity. Mr. Monahan's active chronic conditions — including chronic sinusitis and seasonal allergic rhinitis — combined with an acute upper respiratory infection presenting on the date of service, support the medical necessity and complexity level assigned. The place of service (22 — On Campus Outpatient Hospital) and revenue code 0510 are consistent with the facility setting and service type. Nothing in the claim submission suggests a coding error, duplicate claim, or frequency violation.

We respectfully request that BlueChoice review the claim record in its entirety. If the denial was triggered by an automated frequency edit, we ask that a clinical reviewer confirm that only one unit of one service on one date of service was billed, and that no prior claim for the same service on the same date exists in the system. If a specific frequency limitation is being applied, we request that BlueChoice identify the applicable plan provision and the prior utilization data upon which the denial was based, so that any factual discrepancy may be resolved.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueChoice HealthPlan of South Carolina reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-17FF-1 and reprocess the claim for payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$310.50. Should additional clinical documentation or coding clarification be required to complete this review, please contact the MUSC Health Revenue Cycle department directly. This reconsideration is being submitted electronically via MIM in accordance with the plan's appeal procedures, within the appeal deadline of September 17, 2026.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record